QP: 25901705

Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam

MDC Course: MG2MDCHIS101: Human and Environment

Answer Scheme for Question Paper: 25901705

Short Answer Questions

1. Geography influence resource use. Climate, landforms, water availability, and natural vegetation differ from place to place. Farming in fertile plains; forestry, mining, and tourism in mountainous region; fishing, salt making, navigation in coastal regions; livestock or oil extraction in desert areas.

2. **Annales School:** History is the methodical study of the past using concepts, categories and theories. Annales is a French school of history writing which revolutionized the study of past human societies using the concepts and developments in other branches of the human sciences, such as geography, sociology, and anthropology.

3. **Land Degradation:** The process in which the quality and productivity of land decrease due to natural causes and human activities. It occurs through deforestation, overgrazing, mining, excessive use of chemicals, soil erosion, and improper farming methods.

4. **Reduced life expectancy among Indus people:** Archaeological evidences suggest Harappans had high mortality among them mainly due to difficult living conditions and stressful life in the urban centres. Epidemics like malaria is cited as another reason.
5. **Homo Sapiens:** Literal meaning in Latin, “wise man”. Homo sapiens is a species of highly intelligent primate that includes all living humans.

6. **Hendrik Adriaan Van Reed** As Dutch commander of Malabar in the 17th century, van Reed was responsible for compiling the Hortus Malabaricus, a major publication of the flora and medical use of plants found in Malabar with the intellectual support of native Vaidyans and scholars.

7. **Ecological Imperialism: The Biological Expansion of Europe, 900-1900**. This book is by Alfred W. Crosby. In this book Crosby explore the fascinating historical narrative of Europe's biological expansion from 900-1900. Crosby analyses the complex relationship between between ecology, colonization, and human

migration patterns that shaped modern global history including the exchange of flora, fauna, and pathogens.

8. **Kerala Sastra Sahitya Parishad:** Internationally renowned NGO working in Kerala that focuses on science education, environmental issues and questions of development. KSSP was instrumental in halting the Silent Valley Hydo-electric Project in the 1970's.

Short Essay Questions

9. Dependence on nature for survival by hunter- gatherer-fishers; Stone tools and impact on environment during paleolithic and Mesolithic Ages; Discovery of fire and impact on environment; Agriculture since the neolithic period; taming of rivers and trade in surplus commodities; Discovery of metals and rise of civilizations and impact on environment; impact on environment during medieval period.

10. Metal production requires large scale use of wood, charcoal, coal and coke; metallurgy caused large scale de-forestation and produced heat; warfare required heavy use of weapons like swords, spears, and armours etc., made of metals; discovery of gun powder and the resultant warming up of environment leading to climate change.

11. Forests became a taxable property of the state; existing community ownership and management of forests were dismantled; commercial exploitation of forests continued unabated; forest dwellers lost their right to live in forests and right to access forest resources; rise of plantations and in the forest land new department of forests and legislation to govern forests emerged

12. The forest-dwelling communities lost the control over their traditional habitats; traditional practices like jhum cultivation and hunting were stopped; land alienation among Adivasis and forest-dwelling people; People were displaced over hydro-electric projects; plantations in forest areas made natives into plantation laborers.

13. In the early historic period in the subcontinent, many animals were domesticated for agriculture, transport, trade, warfare, and daily life; Cattle were among the most important; Cows and bulls were used for ploughing fields, transportation, and dairy products like milk, butter, and ghee. Buffaloes were also reared for milk and farm work; Aryans introduced horses in the subcontinent; elephants were another important domesticated animal used in wars, royal ceremonies, and heavy labor. **(Value Liberally)**

14. The Green Revolution in the 1960s by introduced high-yielding varieties of rice and wheat; Before the Green Revolution rice, millets, sorghum, wheat, maize, and barley were the major products. During Green Revolution a number of traditional rice varieties consumed prior to the Green Revolution have become non-existent, and the availability of local rice varieties have decreased to 7000 and not all of these varieties are under cultivation. Thus, India has lost more than 1 lakh varieties of indigenous rice after the 1970s that took several thousand years to evolve. This loss of species is mainly due to the focus given to the production of subsidized high-yielding hybrid crops and the emphasis of monoculture by the government.

15. Mode of Production a Marxian concept; Idea of bourgeoisie and proletariat; high technology; wage labour; commodity production, profit motive; the most advanced mode of production until now

Essay Questions

16. Hunting -Gathering was the largest period of human history; consuming wild animals and gathering of vegetable matter; human muscle power and wood fuel as sources of energy; very rudimentary technology; dogs were domesticated; feeding on naturally available plants, animals and stones; limited knowledge base; nature beyond human control; Hardly any storage facility and transportation; lived as nomadic bands; no gendered division of labour; hardly any adverse ecological impact.

17. Salient features of the subcontinent in the medieval period include, diversity in physical regions; plain lands, mountains, deserts, plateaus, coastal belts etc; settlements, agriculture, trade, shifting political powers; agriculture supported by fertile river valleys and monsoon; irrigation and expansion of cultivation over time; abundant forest resources; ever shifting boundaries of pollical power, resource mobilization, fight for control over delta regions etc.

18. Human dependence on nature for resources lead to deforestation, loss of bio-diversity, soil degradation, resource depletion etc.; pollution and loss of green cover; problems of climate change and global warming; problems of urbanization and waste management; sustainable resource management, conservation and public awareness can mitigate these issues. **(Value Liberally)**

19. Sardar Sarovar Dam: Massive infrastructure project for irrigation and electricity; faces protest due to huge human and environmental cost; raises questions of environmental concerns, justice, resettlement and compensation to project affected people; The Narmada Bachao Andolan (NBA) or 'Save the Narmada' movement originated in the 1980s; Medha Patkar **(Value Liberally)**